# RAG.co Staff Handbook

> Fictional. Part of the RAG.co story in this app, not real terms, people or events.

*Version 1.0, effective Monday 2 November 2026. Issued by the office manager.*

## 1. Welcome

Welcome to RAG.co, the company that looks it up, then writes it down. This handbook tells staff how the office runs on Level 3 of 12 Index Lane, in the Card Catalogue District. It is short on purpose. If a situation is not covered here, ask the office manager, and then check whether it should be added at the next monthly meeting.

RAG.co was founded on 4 October 2026 at a single desk. The building has six rooms: the Query Desk, the Reading Room, the Mail Room, the Map Room, the Kitchen and, on Level 2, the Archive.

## 2. Working hours

2.1. The office is open from 08:30 to 18:00, Monday to Friday.

2.2. Core hours are 09:30 to 16:30. Every member of staff is expected to be reachable during core hours.

2.3. Outside core hours, staff may start early or finish late, provided they work a full day of 7 hours 30 minutes.

2.4. The Query Desk opens whenever a question arrives. Staff on Query Desk duty must be at the counter within two minutes of the bell.

2.5. There is no weekend work unless the office manager asks for it in writing at least 48 hours ahead. Weekend work is repaid with a day off in the following two weeks.

## 3. Lunch breaks

3.1. Every member of staff takes a lunch break of 45 minutes.

3.2. The break must start between 12:00 and 14:00.

3.3. Lunch is taken away from the Query Desk. Eating at the counter is not allowed, because crumbs get into the question slot.

3.4. On a Query Desk day, lunch is never skipped. If the desk is busy, the office manager arranges cover, and the break moves by up to 30 minutes but never past 14:00.

3.5. Staff may eat in the Kitchen, the Reading Room (no soup) or outside. Food is never allowed in the Archive.

## 4. The Kitchen

4.1. The Kitchen has a coffee machine called Bean There. Coffee for members of the Coffee Club is covered in the club's own terms. Staff tea, water and hot chocolate are free.

4.2. Wash your own mug. A mug left in the sink overnight is moved to the shelf marked "Orphans". Mugs on the Orphans shelf for two weeks are given to the charity shop.

4.3. The fridge is cleared every Friday at 16:00 by the facilities team. Anything not labelled with a name and a date is thrown away.

4.4. No fish may be heated after 11:00. The reason is the Reading Room, which shares an air vent with the Kitchen.

4.5. The microwave must be wiped after use. The kettle is descaled on the first Monday of each month.

## 5. Dress code

5.1. The dress code is smart casual. Jeans are fine if they are plain and tidy.

5.2. On Level 2, the Archive can be cold, and cardigans are encouraged. A spare cardigan is kept in the cupboard by the Archive door.

5.3. Staff at the Query Desk wear their name badge at all times.

## 6. Visitors

6.1. Every visitor signs the visitors' book at the Query Desk and wears a green lanyard.

6.2. Visitors are never left alone in the Reading Room or the Archive.

6.3. Members who bring papers for the Mail Room do not need a lanyard, but they must hand the papers over at the counter. Their papers stay in their own folder and are never filed in the shared cabinet.

6.4. Delivery people and the person from Guesswork & Co. who comes to read the sign are allowed as far as the counter and no further.

## 7. When the building goes to sleep

7.1. After a quiet spell, the building goes to sleep. The lights dim, the lift stops and the Query Desk bell is covered with a tea towel.

7.2. When a question arrives, the building wakes. Waking takes up to one minute.

7.3. During that minute, staff wait quietly. Do not press the bell more than twice, and do not take the tea towel off before the lights are back to full.

7.4. If the building has not woken after five minutes, tell the facilities team. Their number is on the back of the Kitchen door.

7.5. The last person to leave in the evening makes sure the lights are dimmed, the Kitchen is clean and the tea towel is over the bell.

## 8. The Archive’s quiet rules

8.1. In the Archive, staff whisper.

8.2. No food and no drink are allowed in the Archive, except the water bottle kept by the Archive keeper.

8.3. One cart at a time. If a cart is in the aisle, wait at the end until it has gone.

8.4. Cards are returned to the drawer they came from, in the order they were taken.

8.5. Never wake Meow. Meow is the office cat, and she sleeps on the third shelf from the window. She is not to be moved, picked up, photographed with a flash or put on a card.

8.6. The warm shelves are for cards and for Meow. Staff may not use them to warm lunches.

## 9. Leave

9.1. Each member of staff has 22 days of paid leave a year, plus the Founding Day holiday on 4 October.

9.2. Leave is requested from the office manager at least two weeks before for any absence longer than three days. A shorter absence needs three working days of notice.

9.3. Leave may not be taken on the day of the monthly meeting by more than two members of staff at once.

9.4. Up to 5 days of leave can be carried into the next year, and must be used by 31 March.

## 10. Sick days

10.1. Each member of staff has 5 sick days a year that can be taken without a doctor’s note.

10.2. From the sixth day, a note is needed.

10.3. Tell the office manager before 09:30 on the first day of sickness. A message is enough.

## 11. Fire drills

11.1. There is a fire drill on the first Tuesday of each month at 10:15.

11.2. The assembly point is the plane tree at the end of Index Lane.

11.3. Leave by the stairs, not by the lift. The lift stops when the alarm sounds.

11.4. The Archive keeper checks that the Archive is empty and closes the door behind them. Meow is carried out last, in her blanket, by the Archive keeper only.

11.5. The facilities team counts everyone at the assembly point and records the time. A drill that takes more than four minutes is run again the following week.

11.6. The first drill under this handbook is Tuesday 3 November 2026.

## 12. The Coffee Club

12.1. The Coffee Club is separate from staff benefits. Its terms are in the Coffee Club terms. Staff are welcome to join as members.

12.2. Bean There serves at most two cups a day per member.

## 13. Conduct

13.1. Be kind, be brief and check before you say.

13.2. Never answer a question you have not looked up. This is the first rule of RAG.co, and the reason the sign across the street, “Sounds about right.”, is not allowed in the office.

13.3. If you do not know, say so. Saying “it is not on the shelves” is a good answer.

# 14. Changes to this handbook

14.1. This handbook is reviewed at the monthly meeting. Changes are recorded in the minutes and take effect on the Monday after the meeting.

14.2. The office manager keeps the master copy at the Query Desk.